

Database Optimization

Data & Database | advanced | 15 min to complete | DeepCharts Help Center | July 20, 2026

DeepCharts stores tick and bar history in a local database that grows with every session. Over time a large database slows startup and eats disk space. By the end of this guide you will have run the **Migrate / Compress** utility, which can reduce the database size by up to 90% and noticeably speed up the platform.

The gains are largest after extended usage and on machines where disk and memory are at a premium — virtual machines in particular (for example, Parallels on a Mac) benefit the most. Alongside the size reduction you get faster startup times, reduced storage usage, and improved overall platform performance.

Before you start

- You know how to disconnect your data feeds — all feeds must be disconnected before the utility runs.
- Your workspace layout is saved — you will close the workspace before starting.
- Pick a quiet time. The process can take several minutes (longer for very large databases), so run it after your trading session or on a weekend — never mid-session.
- On a laptop, connect the power adapter before you begin.

Warning: Do not shut down or restart your computer while Migrate / Compress is running. Interrupting the process can corrupt the database. Laptops must stay plugged in for the duration.

Steps

1. Close your workspace using the workspace dropdown at the top of the main bar (labelled with the current workspace name, for example **Untitled**).

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] The workspace dropdown at the top of the DeepCharts main bar expanded, showing the option to close the current workspace workspace-dropdown-close.png

2. Disconnect all data feeds using the **Feed** dropdown at the top.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] The Feed dropdown at the top of the main bar expanded with the disconnect option visible feed-dropdown-disconnect.png

3. Go to **Options** → **Database** → **Settings**.

4. Select **Migrate / Compress**.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] The Database Settings dialog with the Migrate / Compress option highlighted database-settings-migrate-compress.png

5. Click **Yes** on the confirmation dialog. The dialog itself warns that the operation may take a while and suggests running it after the session or on a weekend.

6. Click **OK**.

7. Wait for the process to complete. Expect several minutes; a database that has grown for months can take longer. Do not close the platform or power off the machine while it runs.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] The Migrate / Compress progress state while the utility is running migrate-compress-in-progress.png

Verify it worked

1. The utility finishes without errors and the platform is responsive again.
2. To measure the gain, compare the database folder size before and after: **Options** → **Settings** → **Various** shows the **Database Folder** path — check that folder's size in File Explorer.

3. Startup should be noticeably faster the next time you launch DeepCharts, especially on a virtual machine.

Tip: Make Migrate / Compress part of your routine maintenance — for example, on weekends after heavy data weeks. Regular compression keeps the database small enough that you rarely need more drastic fixes.

If something went wrong

Symptom	What to do
The process was interrupted (power loss, forced shutdown) and charts now misbehave	Treat the database as possibly corrupted — see Fix: Database Problems
A single symbol shows bad data after compression	Delete and re-download that symbol's data — see Delete Market Data (In-App and Manual Methods) and Re-download Historical Data (Download Data Tool)
Platform is still slow after compressing	Work through the performance checklist in Fix: Charts Lagging or Data Delayed (Checklist)

Related articles

- [Fix: Database Problems](#)
- [Delete Market Data \(In-App and Manual Methods\)](#)
- [Re-download Historical Data \(Download Data Tool\)](#)
- [Fix: Charts Lagging or Data Delayed \(Checklist\)](#)